全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 42 單元 | 動作與移動 · Actions & Movement

Kitten Rescued After Students Refuse to Give Up

學生不放棄，小貓獲救

NEW TAIPEI CITY - A kitten that had been trapped in a storm drain for two days was rescued on Sunday afternoon by firefighters, after a group of junior high school students refused to give up on it. The students, who were wandering along the riverside path after school on Friday, heard a faint cry that seemed to vanish every time a car passed. Lin Yu-ting, 14, said, "We stared at the drain for ten minutes before we saw a tiny paw. Then I screamed because it moved."

The students tried to lift the heavy cover themselves, tugging at it wildly, but it would not shift. One boy even tried to sneak his hand through the narrow gap, only to scratch his arm on the rough edge. Finally, they tapped on the window of a nearby shop and asked the owner to call 119. When the firefighters arrived, they used a special tool to twist the cover loose, and one of them squeezed his shoulders into the opening. The kitten, trembling and soaked with mud, was gently wrapped in a towel and handed to the cheering crowd that surrounded the scene.

Firefighter Chen Wei-lun shrugged off the praise. "The kids did the hard part," he said with a sigh of relief. "If they had tossed the problem aside, this little guy would not have made it." The kitten has since been transferred to an animal shelter in Banqiao, where volunteers scrubbed the mud from its fur and gave it a warm place to settle down. The shelter says the kitten is now stretching, playing, and splashing water out of its bowl, which is a good sign that it will recover. The students plan to visit next week, and if no owner is found, they hope the kitten can be reunited with the people who saved it, this time as a classmate's pet.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
rescue	*v.*	拯救；營救	The lifeguard rescued a boy from the strong waves. 救生員從大浪中救出一個男孩。
wander	*v.*	漫步；閒逛	We wandered around the old town without a map. 我們沒帶地圖就在老城裡閒逛。

vanish	*v.*	消失	The fog vanished as soon as the sun came out. 太陽一出來，霧就消失了。
stare	*v.*	盯著看；凝視	The little boy stared at the huge dinosaur model. 小男孩盯著巨大的恐龍模型看。
tug	*v.*	用力拉；拖	The dog tugged at the rope with all its strength. 狗用盡全力拉那條繩子。
squeeze	*v.*	擠；擠壓	She squeezed the lemon into the tea. 她把檸檬汁擠進茶裡。
tremble	*v.*	發抖；顫抖	His hands trembled as he opened the letter. 他打開信的時候，雙手直發抖。
wrap	*v.*	包；裹	Please wrap the gift in red paper. 請用紅色的紙把禮物包起來。
transfer	*v.*	轉移；調動	The patient was transferred to a larger hospital. 病人被轉送到一家更大的醫院。
reunite	*v.*	（使）團聚；重聚	The lost dog was reunited with its family after a week. 走失的狗一個星期後和家人團聚了。

片語 Phrases

give up on	放棄（某人／某事）	Her coach never gave up on her. 她的教練從未放棄她。
shrug off	對…不以為意；一笑置之	He shrugged off the criticism and kept working. 他對批評不以為意，繼續工作。
settle down	安頓下來；安定下來	It took the new puppy a few days to settle down. 新來的小狗花了幾天才安頓下來。

文法與句型 Grammar

S + V ..., only to + V

only to + 原形動詞表示「結果卻…」，用來說明一個出乎意料或令人失望的結果。

He ran to the station, only to find that the last train had left.

他跑到車站，結果卻發現末班車已經開走了。

If + S + had + p.p., S + would have + p.p.

與過去事實相反的假設語氣：if 子句用過去完成式，主要子句用 would have + 過去分詞，表示「當時如果…，就會…」。

If they had tossed the problem aside, the kitten would not have survived.

如果他們當時把問題丟在一邊，小貓就活不下來了。

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